The Crow and the Pitcher

Name: _____ Date: _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Read the fable carefully. Then circle the best answer for questions 1 to 4 and write full-sentence answers for questions 5 to 7.

One hot summer, a crow had flown for hours without finding a single drop of water. The streams had dried to cracked mud, and the leaves hung limp on the trees. At last, near an old farmhouse, the crow spotted a tall clay pitcher standing in the shade.

She hopped closer and peered in. At the very bottom there was water, cool and clear. The crow pushed her head into the neck of the pitcher, but her beak could not reach. She stretched until her neck ached. Still the water lay far below.

The crow tried to tip the pitcher over. It was too heavy. She tried to break it with her beak. The clay was too thick. She flapped up to the rim and stared down at the water she could not have.

Then she noticed pebbles scattered around the pitcher's foot. The crow picked one up and dropped it in. Plink. The water rose, just a little. She dropped in another, and another. Each pebble lifted the water a tiny bit higher. The crow worked patiently in the heat, pebble after pebble, until at last the water reached the neck of the pitcher and she could drink her fill.

The moral of this fable: little by little does the trick. Thinking wins where force fails.

CIRCLE THE BEST ANSWER

1. What problem did the crow have at the beginning?

a) She was lost.	b) She could not find any water.
c) She could not fly.	d) A farmer chased her away.

2. Why couldn't the crow drink from the pitcher at first?

a) The water was dirty.	b) The pitcher was empty.
c) Her beak could not reach the water at the bottom.	d) The pitcher was too hot to touch.

3. What did the crow try before she used the pebbles?

a) Tipping the pitcher over and breaking it	b) Asking another bird for help
c) Flying to another farm	d) Waiting for rain

4. In the first paragraph, "limp" means

a) bright green	b) drooping and soft
c) covered in frost	d) very small

For non-commercial, education use only

The Crow and the Pitcher

Name: _____ Date: _____

WRITE YOUR ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES

5. How did the pebbles help the crow?

6. Which words in the story show that the crow did not give up?

7. Explain the moral "little by little does the trick" in your own words.

VOCABULARY

Write your own sentence using the word **patiently**.

DRAW IT

The crow dropping pebbles into the pitcher

For non-commercial, education use only

ANSWER KEY: The Crow and the Pitcher

CIRCLE THE BEST ANSWER

1. b) She could not find any water.

2. c) Her beak could not reach the water at the bottom.

3. a) Tipping the pitcher over and breaking it

4. b) drooping and soft

WRITE YOUR ANSWER IN FULL SENTENCES

5. Each pebble took up space in the pitcher and made the water rise a little, until it was high enough for the crow to reach.

6. Words such as "another, and another", "worked patiently in the heat" and "pebble after pebble" show she kept going.

7. Small steps, repeated patiently, can add up to solve a big problem, even when one big effort fails.

VOCABULARY

Any sentence using patiently correctly, e.g. She waited patiently for her turn.

DRAW IT

Drawing is open-ended.

For non-commercial, education use only